If you are not sure if the phrasal verb is formal, informal or neutral, we recommend that you replace it with a single verb equivalent. Here are some common phrasal verbs with the verbs that you can use instead. Highlight/ underline the academic equivalent word used instead of phrasal verbs in the example sentences.

1. Leave out — omit
   To not include someone or something.
   e.g. *She was **omitted** from the list of contributors to the report.*
2. Carry out — conduct
   To do or complete something.
   e.g. *More research on the subject needs to be conducted.*
3. Come out — publish
   To become available for people to buy or see.
   e.g. *The examination results are published in August.*
4. Look at — investigate
   To think about a subject carefully so that you can make a decision about it.
   e.g. *The UN is investigating new methods of population control.*
5. Fill in/out — complete
   To write or type information on a document in spaces that are provided for it.
   e.g. *Companies will encourage customers to complete questionnaires about themselves.*
6. Come about — happen/occur
   To happen, or start to happen.
   e.g. *Such a confusing situation occurred*.
7. Hand out — distribute
   To give something out to several people, or to spread or supply something.
   e.g. *Washington began distributing money to struggling farmers during the Depression.*
8. Make up — constitute
   To be or be considered as something.
   e.g. *The long-term unemployed now constitute a sort of underclass.*
9. Put up with — tolerate
   To be willing to accept someone or something that is unpleasant or not desirable.
   e.g. *The country will tolerate a certain number of economic sanctions.*
10. Find out — discover
    To obtain knowledge of something.
    e.g. *Scientists have discovered how to predict an earthquake.*
11. Stamp out — eradicate
    To get rid of something that is wrong or harmful.
    e.g. *The new legislation is intended to eradicate child prostitution.*

12. Go up — increase/ rise
    To move higher.
    e.g. *The area has recently become very fashionable and house prices are increasing.*
13. Keep up — maintain
    To continue to have; to keep in existence, or not allow to become less.
    e.g. *Several of the teachers were quite unable to maintain discipline.*
14. Set up — organise/ arrange
    To organise things.
    e.g. *A fund was organised as a goodwill gesture to survivors and their families.*
15. Pick out — select/ recognize
    To recognize, find, or make a choice among different people or things in a group
    e.g. *Over 200 people applied for the job, and we had to **select** ten to interview.*
16. Pick up — resume
    To start again after a pause.
    e.g. *The company resumed production of the vehicle again after a two-month hiatus.*
17. Use up — exhaust
    To finish a supply of something.
    e.g. *How long will it be before the world's fuel supplies are exhausted?*
18. Get across — communicate
    To manage to make someone understand or believe something.
    e.g. *This is the message that we want to communicate to the public.*
19. Cut down — reduce
    To do or use less of something.
    e.g. *Wearing the correct type of clothing will reduce the risk of radiation.*
20. Talk about — discuss
    To talk or write about a subject in detail, especially considering different ideas and opinions related to it.
    e.g. *In this essay, the influence of social media will be discussed.*
21. Put forward — propose
    To state an idea or opinion, or to suggest a plan or person, for other people to consider.
    e.g. *A number of theories about the possible causes of cancer have been proposed.*
22. Bring about — cause
    To cause something to happen.
    e.g. *The 20th century caused revolutionary changes in our lifestyles.*
23. Fall apart — disintegrate
    To break into pieces.
    e.g. *Families and communities disintegrate under the crushing burden of drug addiction.*
24. Get along — communicate

To have a friendly relationship.

e.g. *It is crucial for co-workers to communicate within the team as well as with the customers.*

25. Look into —investigate

    e.g. *Researchers have been looking into the problem for 15 years.*

26. Bring up —raise

    e.g. This issue was brought up during the seminar.

27. Step in —intervene

    e.g. It is assumed that the management knows what is happening and will therefore step in if there is a problem.

28. Get rid of— eliminate

    e.g. Schools cannot altogether get rid of the problem of truancy.

29. Cut down —reduce

    e.g. *The number of staff has been cut down recently.*

30. Find out—establish

    e.g. *It was very difficult to find out exactly what happened.*

31. Go up and down —fluctuate

    House prices have a tendency to go up and down.

32. Put forward —propose

    e.g. *A potential solution was put forward two years ago.*

33. Break down — explain

    To explain in more detail, separate into smaller pieces.

    e.g. *Negotiations may end successfully if both parties clearly explain their expectations.*

34. Come across – encounter

    To face

    The employees encountered the problem during their visit.